

Chema Ferrández

Alicante, Spain. Willing to travel • <https://www.linkedin.com/in/chemaferrandez/> • works.c12z.io • work@c12z.io

I am a Growth Product Engineer who builds products, studies why people use them, and figures out how to make them grow. I work across product, engineering and growth, using data, behavioral insights and technology to solve complex problems and build products that scale.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

read it at works.c12z.io

PrimitivoSanchez

Freelance Fullstack Developer & Designer

On site • Spain

July 2026 – September 2026

I developed the corporate website from scratch and modernized the brand identity, retaining the existing logo and colors, with the goal of improving the brand's search engine and AI assistant rankings in Alicante and Murcia and giving it a new "look and feel."

- I designed and developed from scratch the new digital presence for a telecommunications company with more than 40 years of experience, modernizing its online image without compromising its visual identity or brand recognition among its customers.
- I built the full-stack architecture using Astro and React for the front-end, Node.js, Express, and Prisma for the back-end, and PostgreSQL as database, including customer management, personal data, emails, and billing.
- I integrated Google Workspace, Resend, and Factusol to connect communications, forms, and billing processes with the project's infrastructure.
- I developed an SEO and keyword research strategy aimed at increasing the brand's visibility on Google and in LLM-based search engines, focusing on the Alicante, Murcia, and Vega Baja areas using Ranki and Ahrefs and i checked all metadata.
- I set up Google Analytics, Search Console, and Looker Studio to monitor and analyze the site's performance.
- I worked directly with the client throughout the entire process to translate their business needs and brand identity into a digital solution.

Technologies: Astro, React, Node.js, Express, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Resend, Google Workspace, Factusol, Google Tag Manager, Google Analytics, Search Console, Looker Studio and Cookie Bot with Claude Code and Spec Driven Development –SDD.

Spotlife

Growth Product Manager

Remote • Spain

January 2026 – July 2026

Spotlife was an early-stage social network focused on discovering, sharing and saving places through user-generated content and recommendations, with strong network effects around creators and travel content.

I was involved in this project in various ways and across different areas because, although I was hired as a Growth PM, since it was an early-stage company, I had to take on a variety of tasks that weren't solely focused on growth, such as:

- Built the product analytics infrastructure from scratch with Amplitude, defining the event taxonomy, user properties and tracking strategy, coordinating implementation with engineering, creating dashboards in the platform for all team members, and documenting the framework I used so that future teams can understand why and how it works.
- Conducted user interviews and qualitative research to understand how users discovered, saved and shared places outside the product or in other social networks, how and why they traveled, and what his content creation process was like synthesizing feedback into behavioral patterns and growth flywheels that informed product decisions.
- Used these insights to adapt the product around existing user behavior rather than forcing users into predefined flows, shaping acquisition, activation and retention strategies.
- Collaborated with Data Science to translate AI image capabilities into product features, defining data requirements and designing user flows for image recognition, improved spot discoverability and content recommendations.
- Developed the end-to-end growth strategy, mapping acquisition, activation and retention loops and connecting user-generated content and recommendations with the product's B2B monetization model.
- Designed the onboarding experience, defining the information architecture, number and purpose of screens and identifying opportunities to reduce drop-off and increasing activation and, with it, retention by ~17%
- Built internal tools in Python and JavaScript to make uploading and retrieving content easier for creators, marketing and product teams, improving their experience and productivity

Handit AI

Growth & Marketing Lead

Remote • Spain

April 2025 – June 2025

- Developed and executed GTM strategies across two business models: a B2B SaaS offering for self-improving AI agents and an open-source model monetized through infrastructure (IaaS), including the transition between them.
- Defined the ICP with the founder (technical profiles at seed to Series B startups) and built founder-led outreach: prospects sourced through Apollo and LinkedIn, filtered with n8n automations, and personalized messages reviewed by hand to avoid spam.
- Combined outbound with inbound strategies on LinkedIn, Reddit and Product Hunt, improving conversion to pilots by ~20%.
- Built the growth analytics infrastructure from scratch, connecting the Lovable, HubSpot (CRM) and GitHub APIs to measure the funnel.
- Built an AI-powered feedback system with n8n that delivered daily recommendations on content and metrics.
- Redefined the growth strategy for the move to open source: studied how open-source communities work, grow and are governed, and how to monetize infrastructure without giving up the product's IP.
- Analyzed competitors, sought partners and integrations with other open-source projects, and defined the market entry strategy with a referral-based growth loop.

A legal-tech startup that connects citizens with the public financial assistance they are eligible for throughout Spain. Using a form, the platform matches the user's profile with databases of open applications and shows them what assistance they can apply for, how much they are eligible to receive, and how to manage the process—all with legal review by attorneys.

Joined as Growth and later stepped into the CMO role, leading the marketing function and working across acquisition, product, sales and customer success.

- Developed GTM strategies for two markets: families at risk of social exclusion, mainly for rental assistance (B2C), and small businesses looking to go digital (B2B), identifying ICPs through Google Analytics, Typeform and user research.
- Conducted in-depth user interviews to understand citizens' concerns and motivations, tailoring products and upsells to each grant and increasing the number of grants requested and awarded per customer, and with it, profit.
- Designed an Awareness–Acquisition–Activation–Retention–Monetization strategy to educate users on which grants exist and which they qualify for, positioning TTF as the logical, reliable solution.
- Built the growth system from scratch, starting with family and friends and scaling through social media, influencers, email and CRM (Brevo) into acquisition, retention and monetization loops.
- Ran counterfactual quasi-experiments on website, pricing and positioning when traffic was too low for A/B testing, comparing clicks, completed forms and scheduled calls. Together with the new growth system, this reduced CAC by ~20% in under a year and saved over an hour per customer.
- Built dashboards for marketing KPIs, unit economics and LTV to communicate with investors and stakeholders.
- Stepped into the CMO role, leading marketing strategy and working with content, sales and customer success to build trust with skeptical customers and improve the customer journey.

PropTech focused on student housing rentals in Alicante and Murcia. Built and operated the business from the ground up, managing the customer acquisition, digital product, sales and day-to-day operations of 3 properties with 10+ rooms. Some of the skills this taught me were:

- Built and operated the business end-to-end, from defining the business model and acquiring tenants to developing the website, managing sales and overseeing day-to-day operations.
- Conducted customer discovery and user interviews, developing the communication and trust-building skills required to engage both students and property owners and turn conversations into actionable insights.
- Managed the full customer acquisition and rental lifecycle, including lead generation, sales, tenant onboarding and ongoing customer relationships.

- Developed the business model and financial projections, balancing margins across four parties: investors, tenants, property owners and myself.
- Raised and communicated with investors, developing and delivering pitches grounded in real business metrics, financial projections and operational performance.
- Closed the operation after concluding that margins for the investor and me were negligible, and reaching a comfortable profit would require far more time and a much larger volume of properties and tenants.

EnerGym

CRM manager & CrossFit coach

On-site, Alicante • Spain

February 2022 – April 2024

Although it isn't directly related to technology, this experience taught me how to communicate with very different kinds of people, break down complex concepts and movements into simple explanations, and adapt my communication style when something wasn't understood. I also learned how to handle large groups and manage the frustration that can arise when you can't convey an idea the way you expected—by choosing different words or using new metaphors.

- Designed from scratch the CRM with all affiliate CrossFit members.
- Managed CRM for communication with users via email and WhatsApp.
- Developed a survey to find out what were the weak points of the gym, what mattered most to the users and to increase retention.
- Organize CrossFit competitions between boxes to attract new members, resulting in a 22% increase in class registrations and increased the NPS of the gym by 35% with loyalty strategies.
- I created an internal platform so that users could give feedback to the gym so that they didn't know who they were but were registered in the CRM.
- Learned to communicate to large groups of people in a clear, effective and assertive manner.

OWN PROJECTS

qiip.me

A link routing tool

Built qiip.me to solve a concrete problem I repeatedly encountered when publishing content on my own blog: validating content length for reading time and metadata requirements before publishing. The project later evolved after identifying the same friction among colleagues, freelance clients and companies using QR codes and UTMs in their campaigns.

- Built a content analysis tool to calculate reading time and validate title and description lengths against common search engine metadata requirements.
- Expanded the product into a UTM builder and branded QR generator after identifying that marketers, freelancers and businesses were relying on outdated tools for campaign tracking and QR generation.
- Designed and developed the product end-to-end, turning personal friction into a reusable tool for other users and adapting the product based on real feedback and use cases.
- Currently developing convert a web page's HTML into a Markdown file to paste it into LLMs, dynamic QR codes, allowing users to change the destination URL without replacing the printed QR code, and a branded URL shortener for UTM-heavy campaign URLs: `qiip.me/{your_band}/{id_campaign}`

I built this website as a personal tribute to La Vida Moderna, turning my interest in the show into a small digital archive designed to preserve and make its most memorable phrases easily accessible. I love comedy, and I saw this as a small tribute to it.

- Collected, structured and categorized hundreds of phrases from the show, linking them to their original authors and episodes and I used the Fisher-Yates algorithm to randomize the cards
- Built the website from scratch with a focus on simple browsing and discoverability, allowing users to explore phrases by season and trace them back to their original episode.
- Created the project purely for fun and as a way to preserve a piece of Spanish comedy culture in a searchable digital format.

Another projects that I am building right but they are in private beta:

- **squint.me**: A complementary project to qiip.me where you can see in real time whether a URL meets the metadata and schema requirements that browsers need and whether it is LLM-friendly. It also suggests solutions based on the problem detected.
- **aromathic.com**: A “social media network” for recipes. It solves a specific problem I have: my grandmother and my mother have old recipes that are really delicious, and they’re either in handwritten cookbooks or just in their heads, and I’d like to preserve them using speech-to-text. For now, it’s only open to family members.
- **cliima.com**: An app designed to help agricultural engineers and field professionals make decisions based on climate data by centralizing information on rainfall, weather forecasts, and wind and cloud patterns in one place.

EDUCATION & KNOWLEDGE

DAW

Associate Degree in Web Development

Remote • Spain

September 2025 - currently

Technical education focused on the design, development and deployment of web applications, covering both frontend and backend development. Built a strong foundation in programming, databases, APIs, web architecture and software development, with hands-on experience turning requirements into functional web products.

In addition to taking private and self-paced courses on infrastructure, clean code, and programming languages such as TypeScript, Node.js, Express, React, and React Native, as well as platforms like Docker and Kubernetes and databases like PostgreSQL or MySQL, I’ve also learned how to use AI in practices such as TDD and SDD, and with testing harnesses like Hermes and Claude Code or Skills.

Behavioral Science

Currently studying BS to better understand how people make decisions, form habits and interact with products. I consider it an essential complement to Growth and Product because understanding why users behave the way they do allows me to design better experiences, identify behavioral patterns and build products around how people actually think and act, rather than how we assume they should.

Deepened my practical knowledge of Product and Growth, covering retention and engagement, acquisition and activation strategies, monetization, and growth models such as loops and flywheels. The course also explored behavioral psychology, experimentation and network effects, providing practical frameworks for understanding user behavior and designing sustainable product growth strategies.

Continued developing practical expertise across Behavioral Psychology & Design, CRO for SaaS and eCommerce, Marketing Analytics, B2B Growth Marketing, SEO, PPC and Demand Generation, including Account-Based Marketing (ABM).

Applied this knowledge by building an AI-powered knowledge assistant with n8n, Google Drive and OpenAI, allowing me to query my personal notes and instantly retrieve answers across the topics I have studied.

I acquired in-depth knowledge of experimentation and A/B testing with tools such as Amplitude or VWO along with the measurement of experiments through statistical programs such as R along with the whole structure of how to create and run experiments in a controlled, systematic and successful way.

Here I learn technical programming skills from JavaScript, frameworks frontend like Astro, React and Next to Python for Data Science and AI to data bases and backend like SQL, Node and Docker.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS & TOOLS

- Tools & Technologies
 - Growth & Analytics: GA4, Mixpanel, Amplitude, Looker Studio, GTM, Ahrefs, VWO, Hotjar, Clarity
 - CRM & Marketing: HubSpot, Brevo, Salesforce, Airtable
 - AI & Automation: n8n, Lovable, OpenAI, MCPs
 - Development: JavaScript/TypeScript, Node.js, NestJS, Python, Django, SQL, HTML/CSS, Git/GitHub
- Personal
 - Continuous learner: Self-taught and highly curious, constantly exploring new ideas, technologies and ways to solve difficult problems.
 - Writing: I share what I learn through my blog, newsletter and social media, mainly around Growth, Product, Behavioral Economics and Behavioral Design.
 - AI & Automation: Currently focused on AI agents and MCPs, building tools to automate repetitive workflows and solve real problems.
 - English: Intermediate level, currently preparing for the Cambridge B2 Advanced certificate.